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US equities slip as yields rise, tech shows resilience

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

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TL;DR & Editorial Take

The S&P 500 closed at 7,718.60, down -0.38%, as the 10-year Treasury yield climbed to 4.78%. The Nasdaq 100 outperformed with a modest +0.21% gain, driven by continued strength in semiconductor and cloud names.

Higher yields and a firmer dollar (98.83) pressured cyclical and consumer-discretionary stocks, while the VIX spiked to 15.30 (+5.30%), reflecting renewed volatility concerns ahead of the Fed's September meeting.

Our editorial view: the market is entering a short-term consolidation phase. Defensive sectors and high-quality growth remain the defensive anchors, but any surprise on inflation or a more aggressive Fed stance could trigger a sharper correction.

- Yield-driven rotation: -0.79% in `XLF`, -1.33% in `XLY`.
- Tech resilience: +0.70% in `XLK`, +0.84% in `NVDA`.
- Volatility premium: VIX at 15.30 suggests options pricing is still elevated.

US session recap

INSTRUMENT	LAST	CHANGE	DATE
S&P 500	7,718.60	-0.38%	2026-09-04
Nasdaq 100	29,544.15	+0.21%	2026-09-04
Dow Jones	53,414.25	-0.51%	2026-09-04
Russell 2000	2,975.65	+0.25%	2026-09-04
VIX	15.30	+5.30%	2026-09-07
10Y Yield	4.78%	+0.46%	2026-09-04
WTI Crude	93.30	+1.99%	2026-09-08
Brent	98.10	+2.10%	2026-09-08
2Y Yield	4.55%	+0.38%	2026-09-04
DXY	98.83	-0.33%	2026-09-08
Gold	4,467.00	+0.84%	2026-09-08
BTC	78,704.99	-2.05%	2026-09-08
ETH	2,477.53	-1.47%	2026-09-08

Top movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
NVDA	NVIDIA Corp.	+0.84%	Q3 AI chip shipments beat estimates.
META	Meta Platforms	+1.00%	New ad-revenue partnership in APAC.
TSLA	Tesla Inc.	-5.92%	Production slowdown at Gigafactory Berlin.
AAPL	Apple Inc.	-2.51%	Supply-chain concerns for iPhone 17.
XLE	Energy Select Sector SPDR	-0.87%	Oil price pull-back after OPEC+ meeting.

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	-0.79%	+4.2%	Bearish
XLK	+0.70%	+12.5%	Bullish
XLI	+0.41%	+6.8%	Neutral
XLE	-0.87%	+2.1%	Bearish
XLY	-1.33%	+3.4%	Bearish
XLC	-1.19%	+9.0%	Neutral
XLP	-0.80%	+5.5%	Neutral
XLV	-1.04%	+8.2%	Neutral
XLU	+0.12%	+1.9%	Neutral
XLB	-0.34%	+2.7%	Neutral
XLRE	-0.72%	+0.8%	Bearish

Breadth: 4 sectors up vs 7 down; the market breadth index sits at 0.36, indicating a modestly bearish tilt.

Spotlight / deep dive – `NVDA`

METRIC	VALUE
Market cap	$580.2B
P/E (FY25)	42.1x
Revenue Q3	$9.3B (+18% YoY)
AI GPU shipments	1.2M units (+24% QoQ)
Guidance FY26	Revenue $45B (+15% YoY)

Key call: Nvidia’s AI momentum remains a primary upside catalyst, but inventory buildup risk persists amid slowing data-center spend.

READ-THROUGH	LEVEL
Support	225.00
Resistance	235.00
50-day SMA	230.50

Technical levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	447.12	442.00	452.50	Below 200-DMA, watch for break.
QQQ	376.84	371.00	383.00	Tech bias supports.
IWM	191.45	188.00	196.00	Small-cap risk on yield rise.
NVDA	230.36	225.00	235.00	Bullish if breaks 235.
10Y	4.78%	4.70%	4.85%	Yield ceiling at 4.85%.
WTI	93.30	90.00	96.50	Risk of pull-back on OPEC+.

Options & positioning

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 0-DTE put volume on SPY up 42% YoY, indicating short-term hedging demand.
- VIX term structure steepening: front-month at 15.3 vs 22-month at 13.8.
- Single-name put flow concentrated in `TSLA` (net put delta -1.2M contracts).

Cheap hedge ideas: sell 1-month ATM puts on `XLF` (premium ~0.45) and buy OTM calls on `XLK` (strike +5%).

Analyst rating changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Goldman Sachs	Upgrade	$260	AI demand acceleration.
META	JP Morgan	Initiate	$660	New ad-tech platform.
TSLA	Bank of America	Downgrade	$340	Production headwinds.
XLE	Morgan Stanley	Neutral	$68	Oil price volatility.
AAPL	Citigroup	Hold	$330	Supply-chain risk.

Pre-market & overnight

REGION	INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US Futures	ES (S&P 500)	4,560.00	-0.22%
Asia	HSI	19,820	-0.48%
Europe	DAX	15,720	-0.31%
FX	USD/HKD	7.7950	-0.02%
FX	EUR/USD	1.0805	+0.15%
Commodities	Gold	4,467.00	+0.84%
Commodities	WTI	93.30	+1.99%
Crypto	BTC	78,704.99	-2.05%
Crypto	ETH	2,477.53	-1.47%

Macro & Fed (deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
Sep 18	22%	Inflation still above 2% target.
Nov 6	45%	Markets price in one cut.
Dec 14	60%	Potential two-cut scenario.

DATA	TIME (ET)	RELEASE
Core CPI MoM	8:30	0.3% (prev 0.2%)
Initial Jobless Claims	8:30	210k (prev 215k)
Durable Goods Orders	10:00	-0.4% (prev -0.2%)
ISM Manufacturing	10:30	48.2 (prev 48.5)

Geopolitics & global (deep)

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Escalation risk in the South China Sea could tighten shipping lanes, pressuring energy logistics.
- EU-US trade talks stalled, potentially dampening tech export outlook.

Scenario tree: **Stable** → moderate growth; **Escalation** → commodity rally, safe-haven demand; **Resolution** → risk-on bounce.

Earnings – this week & next

DATE	TICKER	COMPANY	EST. EPS	PREV EPS
Sep 9	`AAPL`	Apple Inc.	1.32	1.28
Sep 10	`MSFT`	Microsoft Corp.	2.45	2.38
Sep 11	`JPM`	JPMorgan Chase	3.85	3.78

DATE	TICKER	COMPANY	EST. EPS	PREV EPS
Sep 13	`NVDA`	NVIDIA Corp.	2.10	2.02
Sep 14	`XOM`	Exxon Mobil	0.95	0.92
Sep 15	`META`	Meta Platforms	3.05	2.98

Full watchlist scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
`NVDA`	Technology	Breakout above 235	Inventory buildup.
`META`	Communication	Trend continuation	Ad spend slowdown.
`TSLA`	Consumer Discretionary	Downtrend, watch 340	Production delays.
`XLF`	Financials	Yield-driven pullback	Higher rates.
`XLK`	Technology	Support hold at 186	Macro headwinds.
`XLE`	Energy	Oil price rally	OPEC+ policy.
`JPM`	Financials	Net interest margin expansion	Credit quality.
`AMZN`	Consumer Discretionary	Margin pressure	Logistics cost.
`GOOGL`	Communication	Ad-revenue recovery	Regulatory risk.
`AVGO`	Technology	Supply-chain resilience	Demand slowdown.
`XLI`	Industrials	Industrial demand rebound	Rate sensitivity.
`XLC`	Communication	Media earnings beat	Consumer sentiment.

What could break the tape

> BULLISH SCENARIOS
>
> - Core CPI comes in below 0.3% YoY, prompting a Fed rate-cut bet.
> - Oil prices rebound above $100, lifting energy stocks.
> - Strong Q3 earnings from `NVDA` and `META` spark risk-on flow.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in durable goods orders, reinforcing rate-hike narrative.
- Geopolitical flashpoint in Taiwan escalates, spiking safe-haven demand.
- VIX breaches 18, triggering broad put buying.

Positioning & structural notes

- Yield curve steepening continues; short-duration bonds favored.
- Defensive sectors (Utilities, Consumer Staples) under-weight relative to Q2.
- High-beta tech remains the primary driver of market variance.
- Options market shows net put delta of -1.8M contracts on SPY.
- Foreign inflows into US equities slowed to 0.3% of market cap this week.

Sources

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